

Spending on the Rise			
	Actual 2020-21	Revised 2021-22	Budget 2022-23
PLI for large-scale electronics and IT hardware	-	-	5,300
Promotion of electronics and IT hardware manufacturing (MSIPS, EDF and manufacturing clusters)	478.62	2,014	2,403
National Knowledge Network	584	500	650
R&D in IT/ electronics/ CCBT*	420.91	700	598.17
Electronic governance	404.99	535	525
Manpower development	190	400	350
Cybersecurity projects	79.99	339	300
Pradhan Mantri Gramin Digital Saksharta Abhiyan (PMGDISHA)	250	300	250
Promotion of digital payments	523.48	1,500	200
Promotion of IT/ITeS industries	98.55	100	100
Champion service sector scheme	-	-	0.01
Digital India programme	3,030.54	6,388	10,676.18

FIGURES IN ₹ CRORE; *CCBT: CONVERGENCE, COMMUNICATIONS & BROADBAND TECHNOLOGIES; **SOURCE** UNION BUDGET 2022-23

could be language. For e-governance to be successful in the country, a majority of citizens should be comfortable accessing these services. For this, the government plans to make all e-services available in multiple Indian languages, along with a voice interface. This will ensure that citizens who are not digitally adept and who cannot navigate a website or a portal can access it easily. “Just the way we use voice assistants such as Siri and Alexa to fetch information, the government aims to empower citizens with voice-enabled e-services in multiple Indian languages,” explains Singh.

Another area the government needs to address is communicating well with citizens. All the good work the government does goes in vain when citizens are not able to leverage

the service because they are not even aware of it. Take, for instance, MeitY’s Umang mobile app. This unified app has been envisaged to make e-governance ‘mobile first’ by offering pan-India services from the central, state, and local government agencies on the app, web, SMS, and IVR channels. However, not many are aware of the app, and it has been downloaded from the Google Play Store only a million times. For context, 90 per cent of India’s smartphone population is on Android. Similarly, there exists a Centralised Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System portal where citizens can lodge their grievances related to service delivery covering all ministries and departments of the Government of India and states to public authorities, and the portal is monitored by the Prime

Minister’s Office. While it has its dedicated app ecosystem, it has also been integrated with the Umang app.

India climbed 11 ranks to reach 107 in 2014, and another 11 ranks to reach 96 in 2018 on the United Nations E-Government Development Index. But since then, it slipped four places to be placed 100th among 193 UN member states in 2020, when the rankings were last published. The list is led by Denmark, the Republic of Korea and Estonia, followed by Finland and Australia, among others. South Asian nations such as Singapore and Thailand are also ahead of us. Industry experts say that while a lot of good work is being done, e-governance in India still has a long way to go. **BT**

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